

RE06

Rural Development and Poverty Alleviation in Rajasthan

Rajasthan Economy including schemes runs at 11-15 questions a paper and has been rising. Rural schemes give 2-3 of them, usually as scheme-to-year matching, scheme-to-department matching, or a three-statement question. The employment guarantee change of 2025 is the most likely single new question in the whole subject.

Three out of four Rajasthanis live in villages, so rural development is not a corner of the state's economy - it is the economy. And this chapter has just been rewritten. MGNREGA, the law every aspirant learnt for twenty years, has been repealed and replaced from 21 December 2025. If you write '100 days' in December 2026, you lose the mark.

Rural Development & Poverty Alleviation in Rajasthan

Employment guarantee

- NREGA 2005, in force 2 Feb 2006 (Anantapur)
- Renamed MGNREGA 2 Oct 2009 - 100 days
- REPEALED by VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 (assent 21 Dec 2025)
- New guarantee: 125 days, 60:40 (90:10 NE and Himalayan)
- Rajasthan topped states in person-days

Housing & sanitation

- PMAY-G 20 Nov 2016 (Agra), replaced Indira Awaas Yojana
- Rs 1.20 lakh plain / Rs 1.30 lakh hilly; 60:40
- PMAY-U 25 June 2015, four verticals; PMAY-U 2.0 in 2024
- Swachh Bharat Mission 2 Oct 2014; SBM-G Phase II = ODF Plus

Delivery machinery

- Panchayati Raj born at Bagdari, Nagaur, 2 Oct 1959
- RD&PR department; PHED for rural water
- MPLADS Rs 5 crore; MLA-LAD; SAGY 11 Oct 2014
- SVAMITVA 24 April 2020 - drone survey property cards
- Jan Aadhaar as the delivery backbone

Rajasthan's own guarantees

- Indira Gandhi Shahri Rozgar Guarantee Yojana, 9 Sept 2022
- Urban; 100 raised to 125 days; Local Self Government dept
- Rajasthan Minimum Guaranteed Income Act, 2023
- Extra days for Sahariya (only PVTG) and Kathodi

Water & watershed

- Jal Jeevan Mission 15 Aug 2019 - 55 lpcd, 50:50
- MJSA 27 Jan 2016, Gardan Kheri, Jhalawar - 'four waters'
- DPAP 1973-74, DDP 1977-78, IWMP 2009-10
- All merged into WDC-PMKSY; Rajasthan largest DDP area

Livelihoods

- NRLM 2011, renamed DAY-NRLM
- Rajeevika = Rajasthan Grameen Aajeevika Vikas Parishad
- SHG - village organisation - cluster federation
- Lakhpatri Didi, DDU-GKY 2014, AGEY
- RRLP - World Bank assisted

Food security

- NFSA 2013 - 75% rural, 50% urban
- Priority 5 kg per person; AAY 35 kg per family
- Annapurna Food Packet Yojana, 15 Aug 2023
- Indira Rasoi 2020 - now Shree Annapurna Rasoi (Jan 2024)

The rural setting, and how poverty is actually measured now

Start with the frame. Rajasthan's villages are scattered - dhanis spread thin over a huge area - which makes every rural service expensive to deliver, whether it is a road, a pipe or a wage payment. Poverty here is no longer measured only by income. NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index measures deprivation across three dimensions - health, education and standard of living - using National Family Health Survey data. That framing itself is examinable.

- Rajasthan's multidimensional poverty headcount fell from 29.46 per cent in 2015-16 (NFHS-4) to 15.31 per cent in 2019-21 (NFHS-5).
- The National MPI has three dimensions - health, education, standard of living - and is built on NFHS data.
- Rural development and panchayati raj schemes in Rajasthan are run by the Rural Development and Panchayati Raj Department.
- Rural drinking water and sanitation are executed by the Public Health Engineering Department (PHED).
- Urban schemes - including the urban employment guarantee and the old Indira Rasoi - sit with the Department of Local Self Government, not with Rural Development.

Rajasthan's multidimensional poverty, two rounds

Survey round	Period	MPI headcount
NFHS-4	2015-16	29.46 per cent
NFHS-5	2019-21	15.31 per cent

- Rajasthan's rural relief architecture: the Rajasthan Relief Manual, girdawari-based crop loss assessment, notification of drought-affected villages, cattle camps and fodder depots.

- Girdawari is the field-by-field crop inspection that decides whether a village is declared drought-hit - learn the word, it appears in administration questions too.

MGNREGA - what the law WAS, and why you still have to know it

Write this section in the past tense. MGNREGA no longer exists as law. But you must still know it cold, because the new Act is defined against it and because RPSC has asked its provisions repeatedly. The idea was simple and radical: a household that asks for unskilled manual work in a village must be given it, and if the state cannot give it, the state must pay anyway.

- NREGA was enacted in 2005 and came into force on 2 February 2006, launched from Anantapur district, Andhra Pradesh, in 200 districts.
- It was renamed the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act on 2 October 2009 - Gandhi Jayanti.
- Section 3 guaranteed 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment per rural household per financial year.
- In notified drought-affected areas the guarantee could go up to 150 days.
- It guaranteed UNSKILLED manual work - never skilled employment. That wrong option appears in every set.
- Work within 15 days of the demand, failing which the state owed an unemployment allowance.
- Work normally within 5 km of the village; beyond that, 10 per cent extra wage for travel and living costs.
- At least one-third of beneficiaries had to be women.
- Social audit of works by the gram sabha - the model social audit in Indian governance.

- Gram panchayats had to execute at least 50 per cent of the works by value.
- Rajasthan repeatedly topped the states in person-days generated under MGNREGA.
- Rajasthan gave extra days beyond the statutory guarantee to Sahariya families - the state's only particularly vulnerable tribal group, mainly in Baran district - and to Kathodi families.
- Extra days were also given in drought-notified areas and in tribal sub-plan areas.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked as a three-statement question in RAS Pre 2018 - 100 days of unskilled manual wage employment, 150 days in notified drought areas, social audit by the gram sabha. All three correct. Expect the same three statements to be recycled, this time with the 2025 Act's numbers substituted to trip you.

TRAP

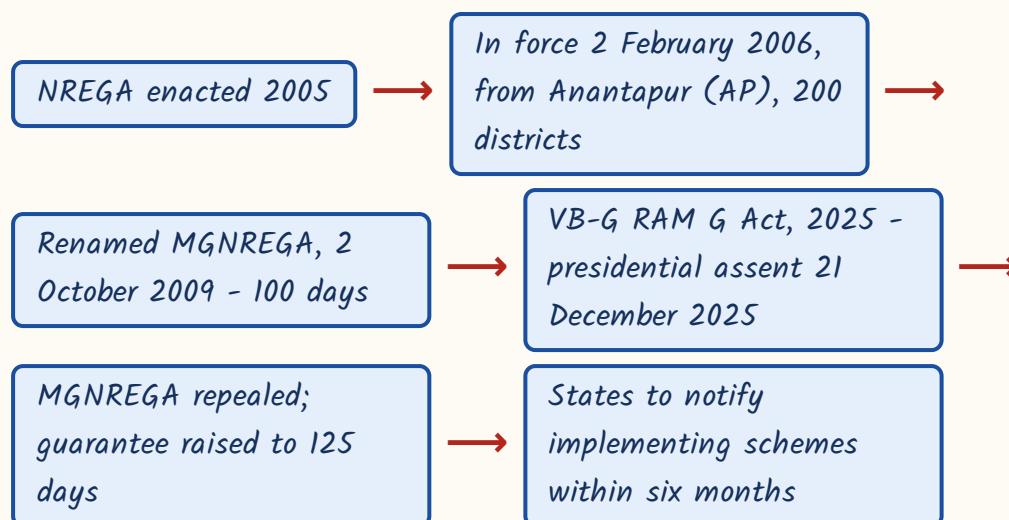
The single most dangerous fact in this chapter. If a 2026 question asks 'the statutory guarantee of rural wage employment is' - the answer is 125 days under the 2025 Act, NOT 100 days. Reserve '100 days' for questions that explicitly say MGNREGA or 'under the repealed Act'.

The 2025 transition - MGNREGA out, VB-G RAM G in

On 21 December 2025 the President gave assent to the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025 - VB-G RAM G for short. It REPEALS MGNREGA, 2005 and puts a new statutory guarantee in its place: 125 days of unskilled wage employment per rural household per

financial year. States were required to notify implementing schemes within six months. Learn the name in full at least once - RPSC likes asking 'which Act repealed MGNREGA'.

The life of the rural employment guarantee



MGNREGA, 2005 vs VB-G RAM G Act, 2025

MGNREGA, 2005 (repealed)	VB-G RAM G Act, 2025
100 days per rural household per year	125 days per rural household per year
150 days in notified drought areas	125-day base guarantee; states may add
Applied to all rural areas	Employment in rural areas NOTIFIED by the Union Government
Cost sharing: Centre bore the full unskilled wage	60:40 Centre-State; 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan states and UTs
No seasonal pause provision	States may pause up to 60 days a year in peak sowing and harvest season
Gram panchayat plans and social audit by gram sabha	Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans using spatial technology, integrated with PM Gati Shakti

- Presidential assent: 21 December 2025.
- Guarantee: 125 days of unskilled wage employment per rural household per financial year.

- Cost sharing: 60:40 between the Centre and general-category states; 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan states and UTs.
- The unemployment allowance survives - work must still be provided within 15 days of the demand.
- Coverage runs in rural areas notified by the Union Government, so it is no longer automatically universal.

ASKED IN RAS

This is the highest-probability new question in the subject. Expect it in one of three forms - which Act repealed MGNREGA; how many days are guaranteed (125); what is the cost-sharing ratio (60:40, or 90:10 for NE and Himalayan states). Learn all three answers together.

TRAP

Do not carry 90:10 across to the Jal Jeevan Mission. Under JJM, a general state like Rajasthan shares 50:50 with the Centre. Under PMAY-G and VB-G RAM G it is 60:40. The 90:10 ratio belongs only to the North-Eastern and Himalayan states.

Rajasthan's own guarantees - the urban scheme and the income law

Rajasthan did something no other state had done. It built an urban twin of MGNREGA, and then wrote a minimum guaranteed income into statute. Both are Rajasthan-specific, both are recent, and both are exactly the sort of thing RPSC pulls from the budget speech.

- *Indira Gandhi Shahri Rozgar Guarantee Yojana - launched 9 September 2022, Rajasthan's URBAN employment guarantee.*
- *Run by the Department of Local Self Government through municipal bodies; job cards are issued on the basis of Jan Aadhaar.*
- *The guarantee was raised from 100 to 125 days per urban family per year in the Rajasthan Budget 2023-24; annual outlay about Rs 800 crore.*
- *Rajasthan Minimum Guaranteed Income Act, 2023 - passed in July 2023; Rajasthan was the FIRST state to legislate a minimum guaranteed income.*
- *The Act guarantees 125 days of employment a year, rural and urban, plus a guaranteed social security pension with an annual increment.*

Three guarantees, one number - keep them separate

<i>Instrument</i>	<i>Rural or urban</i>	<i>Days</i>
<i>MGNREGA, 2005 (repealed)</i>	<i>Rural</i>	<i>100 (150 in drought areas)</i>
<i>VB-G RAM G Act, 2025</i>	<i>Rural</i>	<i>125</i>
<i>Indira Gandhi Shahri Rozgar Guarantee Yojana</i>	<i>Urban (Rajasthan)</i>	<i>125 (raised from 100 in 2023-24)</i>
<i>Rajasthan Minimum Guaranteed Income Act, 2023</i>	<i>Both</i>	<i>125, plus guaranteed pension</i>

- *Sahariya - the only PVTG of Rajasthan, concentrated in Baran district - gets additional days of guaranteed employment; the concession extends to Kathodi families.*
- *Extra days also apply in drought-notified areas and tribal sub-plan areas.*
- *Job cards for the urban scheme come through Jan Aadhaar, which is the delivery backbone for Rajasthan's schemes generally.*

YAAD RAKHO

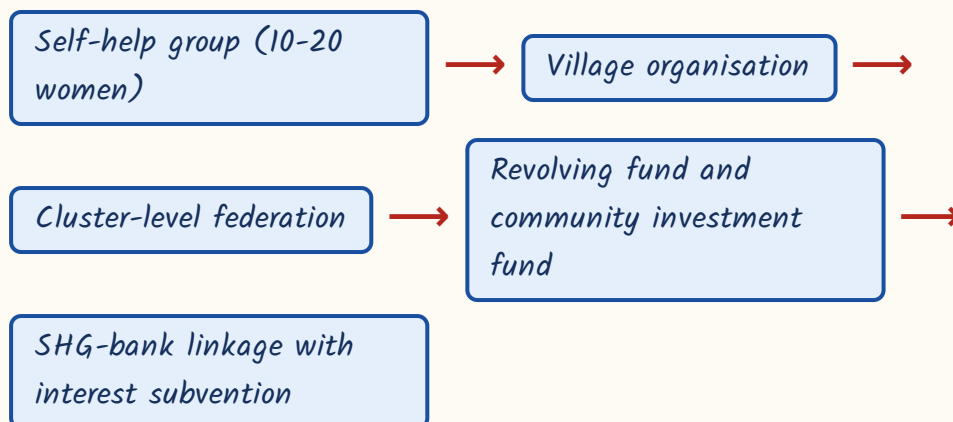
Yaad rakho: 125 is now the magic number in Rajasthan - 125 rural under the 2025 central Act, 125 urban under IGSRGY, 125 under the state's Minimum Guaranteed Income Act. The one place 125 does NOT belong is a question that says 'under MGNREGA'.

Livelihoods - Rajeevika and the self-help group architecture

Employment guarantee gives wages for a fortnight of work. Livelihood missions try to give a permanent income. The instrument is the women's self-help group, federated upward so that it can borrow from banks at scale. Learn the ladder, and learn Rajasthan's name for the mission.

- NRLM was launched in June 2011, restructuring the earlier Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana; it was renamed Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana - NRLM (DAY-NRLM).
- Rajasthan's State Rural Livelihood Mission is RAJEEVIKA - the Rajasthan Grameen Aajeevika Vikas Parishad.
- Financial instruments: revolving fund, community investment fund, interest subvention and SHG-bank linkage.
- Lakhpati Didi aims to raise the annual household income of SHG women to at least one lakh rupees; in Rajasthan it runs through Rajeevika.

The SHG ladder under DAY-NRLM



- DDU-GKY, launched 25 September 2014, is the placement-linked skill training arm of DAY-NRLM for rural youth aged 15-35.
- Aajeevika Grameen Express Yojana lets SHGs run rural transport services.
- The Rajasthan Rural Livelihoods Project (RRLP) is the World Bank-assisted livelihoods project focused on tribal sub-plan and backward blocks.
- Rajasthan Gramin Haat gives SHG and rural producers a marketing outlet.
- Match carefully: DDU-GKY = placement-linked skilling; PMAY-G = rural housing; SVAMITVA = property cards; Rajeevika = SHG livelihoods. That exact four-way match has been set before.
- DDU-GKY is rural - do not confuse it with the urban livelihood mission (DAY-NULM).

Housing and sanitation - PMAY and Swachh Bharat

Two flagship programmes, two different ministries' worth of detail, and one recurring examiner's trick - swapping the rural and urban versions. PMAY-Gramin builds houses in villages and replaced the old Indira Awaas Yojana. PMAY-Urban works through four verticals in towns. Swachh Bharat is sanitation, not housing.

- PMAY-Gramin was launched on 20 November 2016 from Agra, effective retrospectively from 1 April 2016, replacing the Indira Awaas Yojana.

- Unit assistance: Rs 1.20 lakh in plain areas, Rs 1.30 lakh in hilly, difficult and IAP districts.
- Centre-State sharing 60:40 for general states such as Rajasthan.
- Beneficiaries are identified from SECC 2011 deprivation data, verified by the gram sabha, and supplemented by the Awaas+ list.
- 90 to 95 days of unskilled wage from the rural employment guarantee programme is available by convergence - the house and the wage come together.

Housing and sanitation at a glance

Programme	Launched	Core feature
PMAY-Gramin	20 November 2016 (from Agra)	Replaced Indira Awaas Yojana; Rs 1.20/1.30 lakh unit assistance
PMAY-Urban	25 June 2015	Four verticals; PMAY-U 2.0 launched 2024
Swachh Bharat Mission	2 October 2014	ODF India target 2 October 2019
SBM-Gramin Phase II	2020-21 onwards	ODF Plus - solid and liquid waste management

- PMAY-Urban's four original verticals: In-situ Slum Redevelopment, Credit Linked Subsidy Scheme, Affordable Housing in Partnership, Beneficiary-Led Construction.
- Affordable Rental Housing Complexes for migrant workers came later, in 2020, as a separate sub-scheme - it was NOT one of the four original verticals.
- PMAY-U 2.0 was launched in 2024.
- Swachh Bharat Mission, 2 October 2014, targeted an open-defecation-free India by 2 October 2019 - the 150th birth anniversary of Mahatma Gandhi.
- SBM-Gramin Phase II, from 2020-21, sustains ODF status and adds solid and liquid waste management, which together make a village ODF Plus.

- SBM-G is sanitation. Pairing it with 'rural housing for the poor' is the standard wrong option.

Water - Jal Jeevan Mission, MJSA and the watershed programmes

In a desert state, water schemes are rural development. Three layers matter - piped water to the house (JJM), local rainwater harvesting (MJSA), and the older area-development programmes that treated whole watersheds. Get the launch dates and the funding ratio right; that is what is asked.

- Jal Jeevan Mission, launched 15 August 2019 - a functional household tap connection giving 55 lpcd of water of BIS 10500 quality.
- Village Water and Sanitation Committees and gram panchayats operate and maintain the schemes.
- Centre-State sharing for Rajasthan is 50:50.
- JJM 2.0 was approved in March 2026 with an outlay of about Rs 8.69 lakh crore and a target of December 2028.
- Mukhyamantri Jal Swavlamban Abhiyan (MJSA) was launched on 27 January 2016 from Gardan Kheri village, Jhalawar district.
- It used the 'four waters' concept - rainwater, surface water, groundwater and soil moisture.
- Its distinctive funding feature was community crowd-funding and public contributions alongside state funds.
- Phase-I covered 3,529 villages across 295 panchayat samitis.

Area development and watershed programmes

Programme	Launched	Focus
Drought Prone Areas Programme (DPAP)	1973-74	Drought-prone districts

Programme	Launched	Focus
Desert Development Programme (DDP)	1977-78	Hot arid (Rajasthan, Gujarat, Haryana) and cold arid areas
Integrated Watershed Management Programme (IWMP)	2009-10	Integrated watershed treatment
Watershed Development Component, PMKSY	Current	All three merged into it

- Rajasthan has the **LARGEST** area in the country under the Desert Development Programme - a straightforward one-liner.
- DDP covered cold arid areas too (Ladakh, Himachal), not only the Thar - that is the catch in the definition.
- Drought management in Rajasthan runs on the Relief Manual: girdawari crop-loss assessment, notification of affected villages, cattle camps and fodder depots.

Food security - from the NFSA down to the food packet and the rasoī

Rajasthan's food security has three layers stacked on each other. The central law gives grain. The state adds a free monthly packet of the things grain alone cannot provide - dal, oil, salt, spices. And a subsidised kitchen feeds whoever walks in. Learn what each layer gives, because the paper matches entitlement to instrument.

- National Food Security Act, 2013 covers up to 75 per cent of the rural population and 50 per cent of the urban population.
- Priority households: 5 kg of foodgrain per person per month. Antyodaya households: 35 kg per family per month.

- The Act also gives a legal entitlement to maternity benefit for pregnant and lactating women, and a food security allowance if grain is not supplied.
 - Under the NFSA the eldest woman of the household is deemed the head for ration card purposes.
 - Antyodaya Anna Yojana was launched on 25 December 2000 for the poorest of the poor, initially one crore families, at 25 kg (later 35 kg) per family per month.
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- Mukhyamantri Nishulk Annapurna Food Packet Yojana - launched 15 August 2023 for NFSA families.
 - Each free monthly packet: 1 kg chana dal, 1 kg sugar, 1 kg iodised salt, 1 litre soyabean refined oil, 100 g each of chilli and coriander powder, 50 g turmeric.
 - Distributed through fair price shops using point-of-sale machines.
 - Wheat flour is NOT in the packet - wheat and rice come separately under the NFSA. That is the trick option.
 - It is meant primarily FOR NFSA families, not for families outside the NFSA.
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- Indira Rasoi Yojana was launched on 20 August 2020 with the slogan 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye' - a wholesome meal for Rs 8, with a state subsidy of Rs 17.
 - It was renamed Shree Annapurna Rasoi Yojana in January 2024.
 - It is an URBAN scheme run through urban local bodies under the Department of Local Self Government - not a village scheme of the Rural Development Department.
 - Match the entitlements: AAY = 35 kg per family; NFSA priority = 5 kg per person; Annapurna Food Packet = free commodity packet; Shree Annapurna Rasoi = cooked meal at a subsidised price.

ASKED IN RAS

Asked in RAS Pre 2024 - when was the Mukhyamantri Nishulk Annapurna Food Packet Yojana launched? August 2023. Asked in RAS Pre 2023 - Indira Rasoi Yojana was renamed as? Shree Annapurna Rasoi Yojana.

ASKED IN RAS

Know this quirk. The RAS 2023 question built on the slogan 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye' was disputed, because candidates split between Indira Rasoi and the Annapurna Food Packet. The slogan belongs to Indira Rasoi (2020), now Shree Annapurna Rasoi. Read such a question twice before choosing.

YAAD RAKHO

Trick for the packet contents: DAL, SUGAR, SALT, OIL and three spices - chilli, coriander, turmeric. Seven items, no cereal. If an option contains atta, rice or wheat, it is wrong.

The delivery machinery - panchayats, MPs, MLAs and property cards

Every scheme in this chapter is delivered through the same machinery - the three-tier panchayat below, the Jan Aadhaar database sideways, and a set of small area-development funds on top. Rajasthan's claim here is historic: the country's Panchayati Raj system was inaugurated in this state.

- Rajasthan was the FIRST state in India to introduce Panchayati Raj - inaugurated by Jawaharlal Nehru at Bagdari, Nagaur district, on 2 October 1959, following the Balwant Rai Mehta Committee report.

- That single fact links this chapter to Rajasthan Polity - expect it in either subject.
- Gram panchayats execute a large share of rural works and conduct social audit through the gram sabha.
- MPLADS (1993) gives each Member of Parliament Rs 5 crore a year for local works - not Rs 25 crore, which is the standard wrong option.
- Rajasthan runs a parallel MLA Local Area Development scheme.
- Sansad Adarsh Gram Yojana, launched 11 October 2014 on Jayaprakash Narayan's birth anniversary - each MP adopts gram panchayats and develops them as Adarsh Grams through convergence of existing schemes, with NO separate funds.
- SVAMITVA, launched 24 April 2020, uses drone survey to issue record-of-rights property cards for inhabited rural abadi land.
- Jan Aadhaar is the state's single family identity and delivery backbone - job cards, pensions, food packets and cash transfers all key off it.
- Scheme-to-department matching is a standing question: urban employment guarantee to Local Self Government; rural piped water to PHED; food packet to Food and Civil Supplies; rural employment guarantee to Rural Development and Panchayati Raj.

CURRENT LINK

Current link, as of September 2026: the VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 is in its first year of rollout, with states notifying implementing schemes and Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans replacing the old MGNREGA labour budgets. JJM 2.0, approved in March 2026, runs to December 2028. Any 2026 current-affairs question on rural development will most likely come from one of these two.

REVISION RECAP

1. Rajasthan's MPI headcount fell from 29.46 per cent (2015-16, NFHS-4) to 15.31 per cent (2019-21, NFHS-5); National MPI = health, education, standard of living.

2. NREGA in force 2 February 2006 from Anantapur; renamed MGNREGA on 2 October 2009.
3. MGNREGA gave 100 days (150 in notified drought areas), work in 15 days or unemployment allowance, 5 km radius else 10 per cent extra wage, one-third women, gram sabha social audit.
4. MGNREGA is REPEALED - by the Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act, 2025, assent 21 December 2025.
5. New guarantee: 125 days per rural household; 60:40 Centre-State, 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan states; rural areas notified by the Union Government.
6. New Act extras: up to 60-day seasonal pause, Viksit Gram Panchayat Plans with spatial technology and PM Gati Shakti; states to notify schemes within six months.
7. Rajasthan repeatedly topped states in MGNREGA person-days; extra days for Sahariya (only PVTG, Baran) and Kathodi families.
8. Indira Gandhi Shahri Rozgar Guarantee Yojana - 9 September 2022, URBAN, Local Self Government dept, 100 raised to 125 days, job cards via Jan Aadhaar.
9. Rajasthan Minimum Guaranteed Income Act, 2023 (July 2023) - first state to legislate it; 125 days plus a pension with annual increment.
10. NRLM 2011, now DAY-NRLM; Rajasthan's mission is Rajeevika; ladder = SHG, village organisation, cluster-level federation; Lakhpati Didi rides on it.
11. DDU-GKY (25 September 2014) - placement-linked skilling for rural youth 15-35; AGEY = SHG-run rural transport; RRLP is World Bank assisted.
12. PMAY-G - 20 November 2016 from Agra, effective 1 April 2016, replaced Indira Awaas Yojana; Rs 1.20 lakh plain / Rs 1.30 lakh hilly; 60:40; SECC 2011 plus Awaas+.
13. PMAY-U - 25 June 2015, four verticals (ISSR, CLSS, AHP, BLC); rental housing came in 2020, not an original vertical; PMAY-U 2.0 in 2024.
14. SBM 2 October 2014, ODF target 2 October 2019; SBM-G Phase II from 2020-21 = ODF Plus with solid and liquid waste management.
15. JJM 15 August 2019 - 55 lpcd, BIS 10500, VWSCs; 50:50 for Rajasthan; JJM 2.0 approved March 2026, target December 2028.
16. MJSA - 27 January 2016 from Gardan Kheri, Jhalawar; 'four waters' concept; crowd-funding; Phase-I 3,529 villages, 295 panchayat samitis.
17. DPAP 1973-74, DDP 1977-78, IWMP 2009-10 - all merged into the Watershed Development Component of PMKSY; Rajasthan has the largest DDP area.
18. NFSA 2013 - 75 per cent rural, 50 per cent urban; priority 5 kg per person, AAY (25 December 2000) 35 kg per family; maternity benefit is a legal entitlement.
19. Annapurna Food Packet Yojana - 15 August 2023, free monthly packet of chana dal, sugar, salt, oil and three spices; no atta or rice.

20. Indira Rasoi (20 August 2020, 'Koi Bhookha Na Soye', Rs 8 meal with Rs 17 subsidy) renamed Shree Annapurna Rasoi in January 2024; Panchayati Raj began at Bagdari, Nagaur, 2 October 1959.